ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 56

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

# My First Amharic Alphabet

## የአማርኛ ፊደል መጽሐፌ

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 33 Amharic Letters with English Phonetics

ሀ ለ ሐ መ ሠ ረ

**Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza**

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

**Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah**

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

**REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication**

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**My First Amharic Alphabet** — የአማርኛ ፊደል መጽሐፌ
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 56

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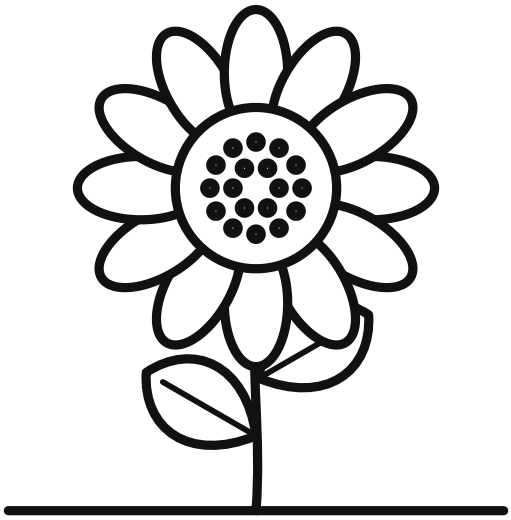
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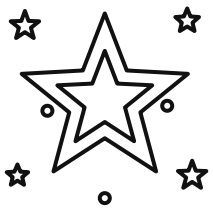
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**A note of respect:** this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.

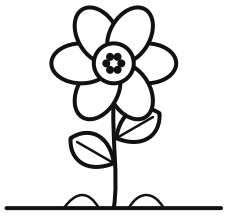


# This book belongs to
## ይህ መጽሐፍ የእኔ ነው

I started learning Amharic on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

# The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

*ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"*

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

*Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.*

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

**Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4**[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

**What does *al-bayān* mean?** It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

# Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

*Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.*

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

**Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22**[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

*Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.*

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

**Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)**[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

### How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

**Book 56 is Amharic**. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

# How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

**Marker tip:** every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

### Reading the English sound guides

- Vowels: **e** as in "the" · **u** as in "rule" · **i** as in "ski" · **a** as in "father" · **é** as in "café" · **o** as in "go". **(i)** is a very quick 'i', often silent.
- An **apostrophe after a consonant** (*q, t', ch', p', ts'*) marks a **popped** sound: hold your breath, then let it burst out.
- An apostrophe **between vowels** (*se-'at*) is a tiny catch in the throat, like the middle of "uh-oh".
- **ny** as in "canyon"; **zh** like the 's' in "measure". Hyphens split the syllables; say them all evenly.

### Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Amharic name** written in Amharic (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *The … family · 7 sounds* shows the letter's **whole family**: the base letter and its six vowel forms, each with its sound. The shaded form is the one that starts the word on that page.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow the Amharic of Addis Ababa.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

# Hello, Amharic! አማርኛ

*a-ma-ri-nya — the Amharic word for the language*

**Who speaks it?**
About **57 million people** speak Amharic: more than half of them from birth, the rest as a second language.[3]

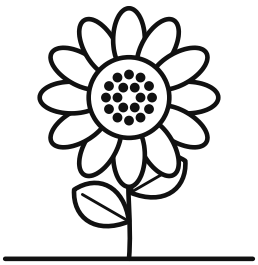
**Where?**
All over **Ethiopia**, in East Africa, especially in the highlands and the capital **Addis Ababa**, and in Ethiopian families around the world.

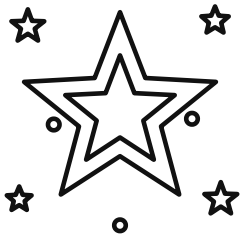
**How is it written?**
In the **fidel** (ፊደል), from **left to right**. Each letter is a whole syllable, like *ba* or *mo*.

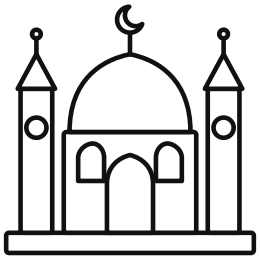
**How many letters?**
**33 letter families**, each with **7 forms**: more than 200 letters, all made from a few simple shapes!

**Did you know?**
The first Muslims to leave Makkah for safety travelled to **al-Ḥabasha** (Abyssinia), where the just king, **an-Najāshī**, welcomed and protected them.

**13 months!**
The Ethiopian calendar has **13 months**: twelve of 30 days and one short month, ጳጉሜ, of 5 or 6 days.







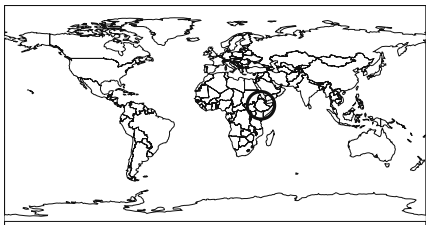
THE WHOLE ALPHABET

# The Amharic Alphabet ፊደል

## 33 letter families – ፊደል

| | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ሀ *ha* | ለ *le* | ሐ *hameru ha* | መ *me* | ሠ *negusu se* | ረ *re* | ሰ *isatu se* |
| ሸ *she* | ቀ *qe* | በ *be* | ቨ *ve* | ተ *te* | ቸ *che* | ኀ *bizuhanu ha* |
| ነ *ne* | ኘ *nye* | አ *alfaw a* | ከ *ke* | ወ *we* | ዐ *aynu a* | ዘ *ze* |
| ዠ *zhe* | የ *ye* | ደ *de* | ጀ *je* | ገ *ge* | ጠ *t'e* | ጨ *ch'e* |
| ጰ *p'e* | ጸ *ts'elotu ts'e* | ፀ *ts'ehayu ts'e* | ፈ *fe* | ፐ *pe* | | |

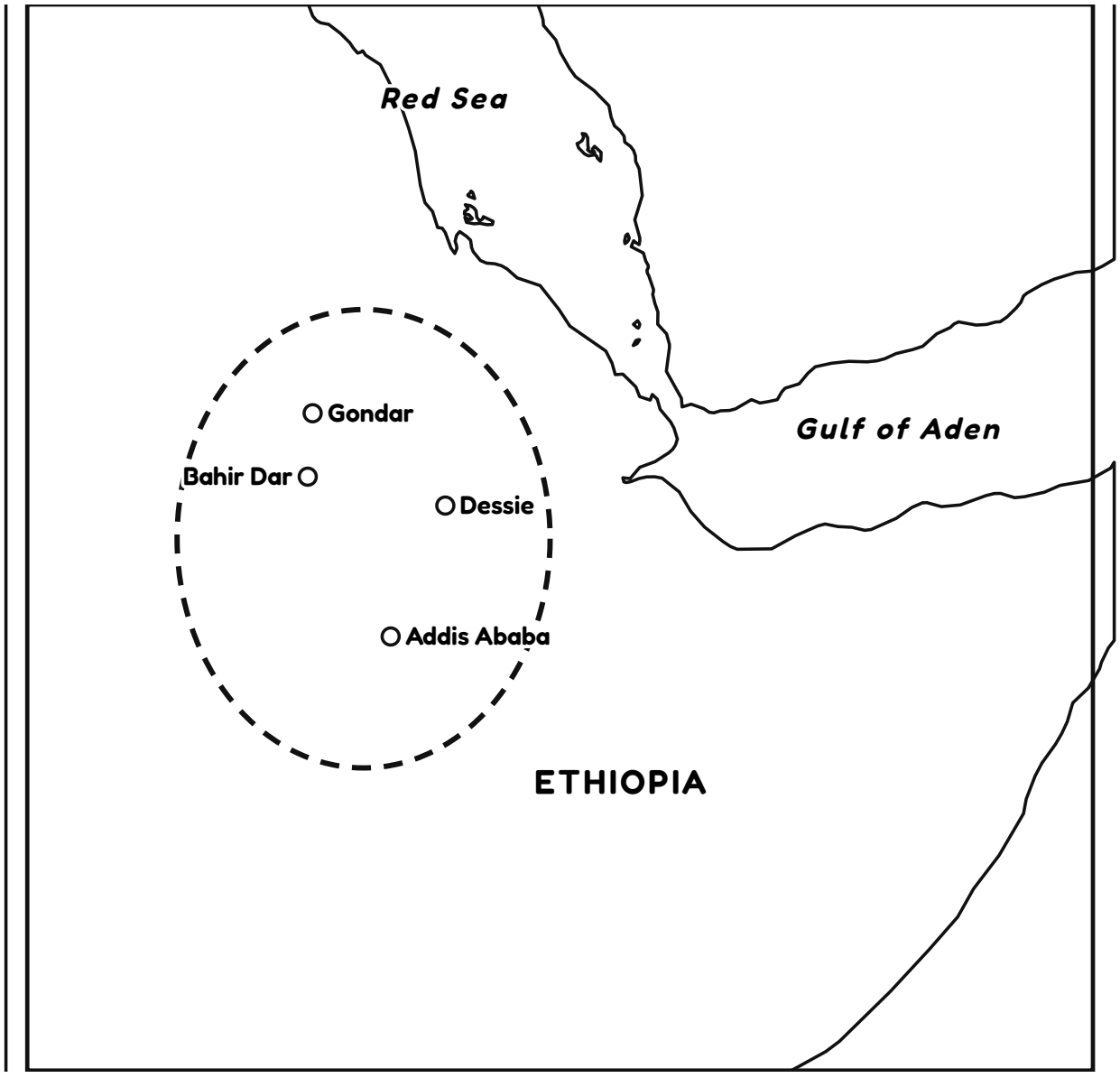
Read the alphabet row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows the Horn of Africa on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

# Where is Amharic spoken?




**Color it:** the land **green** · the seas **blue**. **Find it:** Amharic is spoken all over Ethiopia. The dashed line shows the highlands around Gondar, Bahir Dar and Dessie, where most families speak it at home, and the capital, Addis Ababa.

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# The Fidel ፊደል

*fi-del — “the letters”*

Amharic is written with the **fidel** (ፊደል). Every letter stands for a whole **syllable**: a consonant *and* a vowel together. This book teaches **33 letter families**.

### One family, seven sounds

Each family starts with its **base letter** (the 1st form). Small changes to its shape give six more forms, one for each vowel. Read the grid across: *le, lu, li, la, lé, l(i), lo*.

| 1st<br>ግዕዝ | 2nd<br>ካዕብ | 3rd<br>ሣልስ | 4th<br>ራብዕ | 5th<br>ኃምስ | 6th<br>ሳድስ | 7th<br>ሳብዕ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **-e** | **-u** | **-i** | **-a** | **-é** | **-(i)** | **-o** |
| ለ<br>*le* | ሉ<br>*lu* | ሊ<br>*li* | ላ<br>*la* | ሌ<br>*lé* | ል<br>*l(i)* | ሎ<br>*lo* |
| መ<br>*me* | ሙ<br>*mu* | ሚ<br>*mi* | ማ<br>*ma* | ሜ<br>*mé* | ም<br>*m(i)* | ሞ<br>*mo* |
| በ<br>*be* | ቡ<br>*bu* | ቢ<br>*bi* | ባ<br>*ba* | ቤ<br>*bé* | ብ<br>*b(i)* | ቦ<br>*bo* |

The forms are called ግዕዝ ካዕብ ሣልስ ራብዕ ኃምስ ሳድስ ሳብዕ (*ge'ez, ka'ib, salis, rabi', hamis, sadis, sabi'*): 1st to 7th.

### Spot the vowel marks

2nd: a little stroke on the right (ሉ) · 3rd: a foot on the right leg (ሊ) · 4th: a leg that grows or bends (ላ) · 5th: a little ring (ሌ) · 6th: a bent or broken leg (ል) · 7th: a ring or a shorter leg (ሎ).

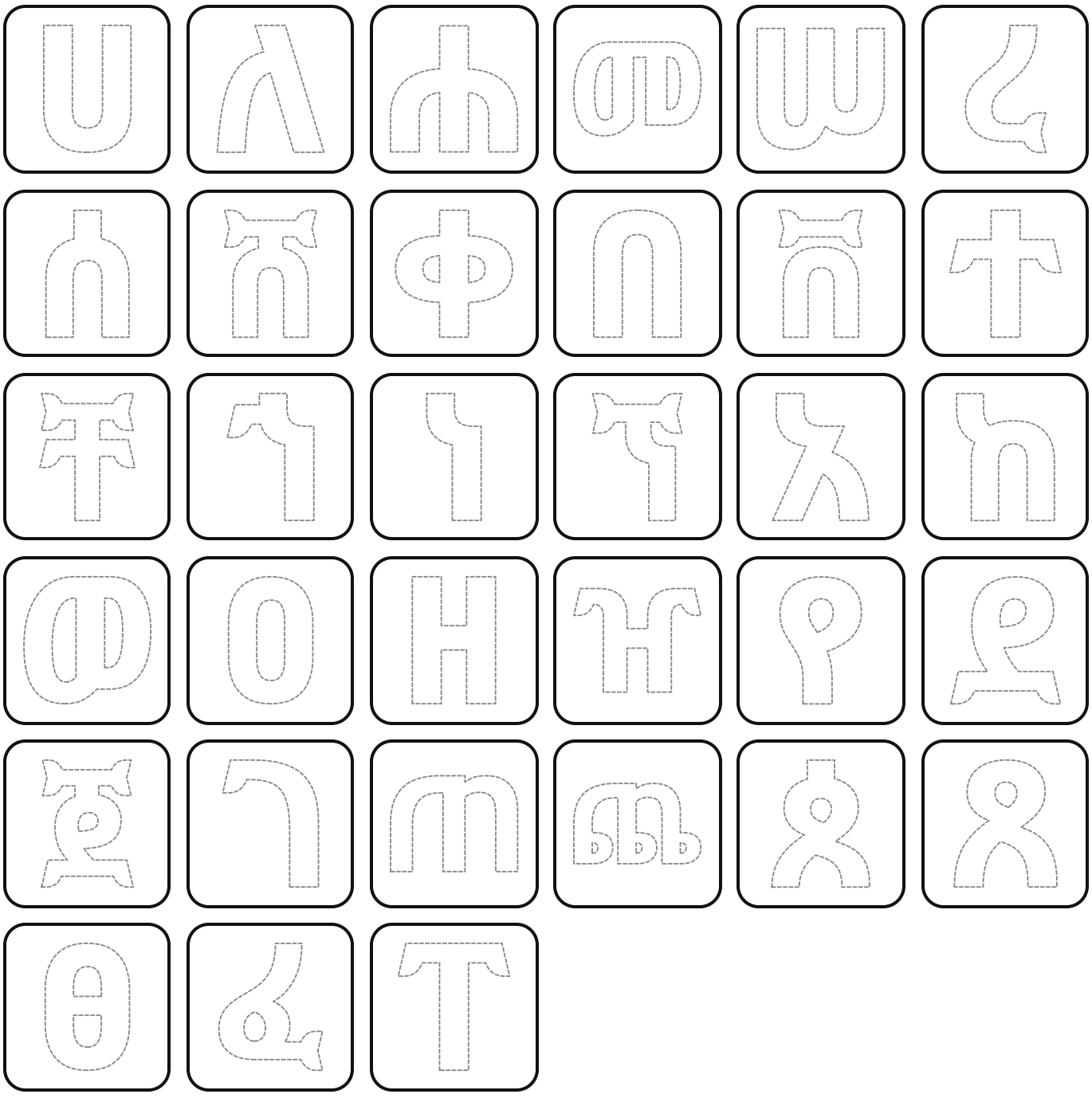
### On every letter page

The big letter is the **base form**. The box *The … family · 7 sounds* shows all seven forms; the **shaded** one is the sound that begins the word on that page. Some families have an extra ‘-wa’ form too, like ሏ *lwa*. The letter ኸ is used in a few words only, so it has no page here.

PENCIL WARM-UP

# Trace the base letters ፊደል

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



# ሀ

**NAME · ስም**

## ሀ

*ha*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

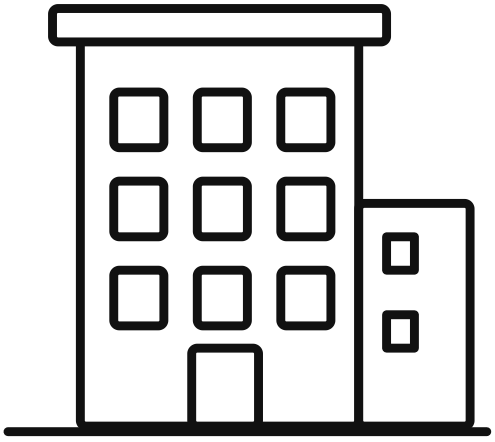
‘h’ as in “hat”

**THE ሀ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS**

| ሀ | ሁ | ሂ | ሃ | ሄ | ህ | ሆ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *ha* 1st | *hu* 2nd | *hi* 3rd | *ha* 4th | *hé* 5th | *h(i)* 6th | *ho* 7th |

ህ *hi*, the **6th** sound of this family, starts the word ህንፃ.

In Amharic ሀ ሐ ኀ all say ‘h’. Children tell them apart by their nicknames.



**ሀ IS FOR**

## ህንፃ

*hin-ts'a*

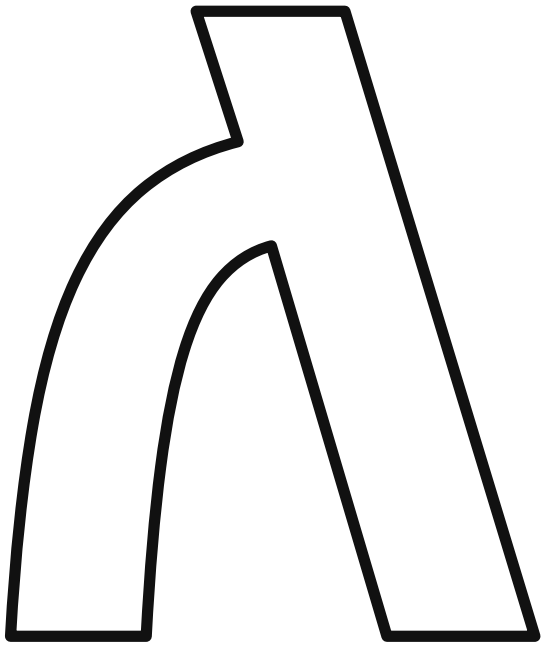
**building**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ**

ሀ ሀ ሀ ሀ

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**NAME · ስም**

# ለ

*le*

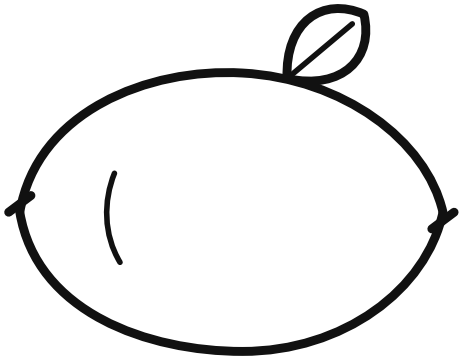
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'l' as in "lamp"

**THE ለ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS**

| ለ | ሉ | ሊ | ላ | ሌ | ል | ሎ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *le* 1st | *lu* 2nd | *li* 3rd | *la* 4th | *lé* 5th | *l(i)* 6th | *lo* 7th |

ሎ *lo*, the **7th** sound of this family, starts the word ሎሚ.



**ለ IS FOR**

# ሎሚ

*lo-mi*

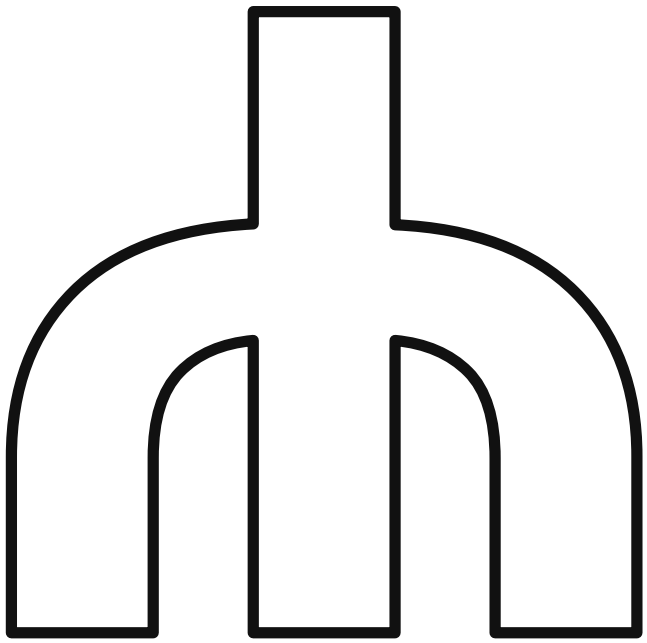
**lemon**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ**

ለ ለ ለ ለ

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NAME · ስም

# ሐመሩ ሐ

*hameru ha*

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

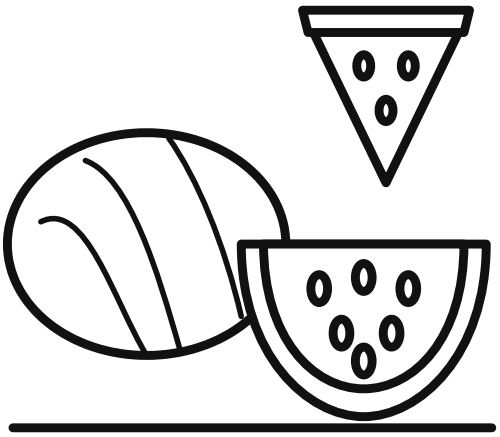
‘h’ as in “hat” — the same sound as ሀ

THE ሐ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

| ሐ | ሑ | ሒ | ሓ | ሔ | ሕ | ሖ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *ha* 1st | *hu* 2nd | *hi* 3rd | *ha* 4th | *hé* 5th | *h(i)* 6th | *ho* 7th |

ሐ *ha*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ሐብሐብ.

In Amharic ሀ ሐ ኀ all say ‘h’. Children tell them apart by their nicknames.



ሐ IS FOR

# ሐብሐብ

*hab-hab*

**watermelon**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ

ሐ ሐ ሐ ሐ

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# መ

NAME · ስም

**መ**

*me*

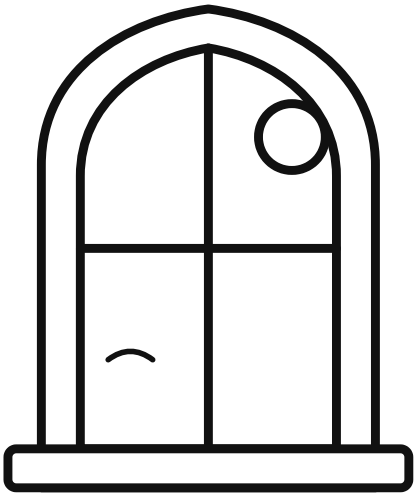
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'm' as in "moon"

THE መ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

| መ | ሙ | ሚ | ማ | ሜ | ም | ሞ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *me* 1st | *mu* 2nd | *mi* 3rd | *ma* 4th | *mé* 5th | *m(i)* 6th | *mo* 7th |

መ *me*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word መስኮት.



መ IS FOR

## መስኮት

*mes-kot*

**window**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ

መ መ መ መ

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# ሠ

NAME · ስም

## ንጉሡ ሠ

*negusu se*

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

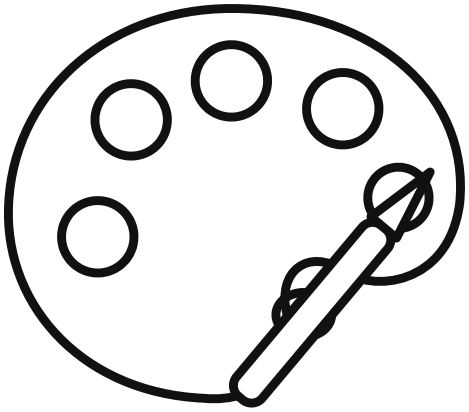
‘s’ as in “sun” — the same sound as ሰ

THE ሠ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

| ሠ | ሡ | ሢ | ሣ | ሤ | ሥ | ሦ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *se* 1st | *su* 2nd | *si* 3rd | *sa* 4th | *sé* 5th | *s(i)* 6th | *so* 7th |

ሥ *si*, the **6th** sound of this family, starts the word ሥዕል.

ሠ and ሰ sound the same; each is kept in its own words.



ሠ IS FOR

## ሥዕል

*si-'il*

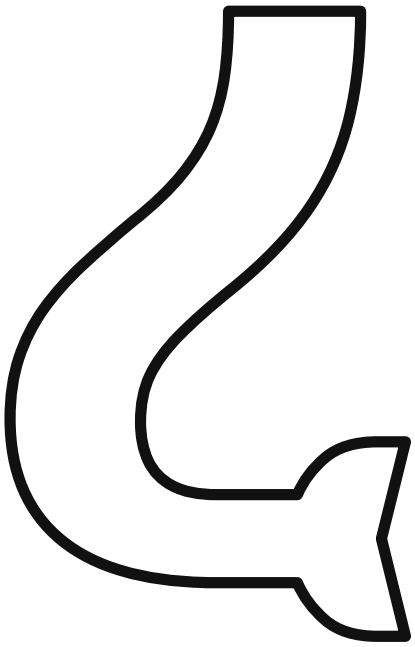
**picture, painting**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ

ሠ ሠ ሠ ሠ

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**NAME · ስም**

# ሬ

*re*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

a quick tapped ‘r’, as in Spanish “pero”

**THE ሬ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS**

| ሬ | ሩ | ሪ | ራ | ሬ | ር | ሮ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *re* 1st | *ru* 2nd | *ri* 3rd | *ra* 4th | *ré* 5th | *r(i)* 6th | *ro* 7th |

ሩ *ru*, the **2nd** sound of this family, starts the word ሩዝ.



**ሬ IS FOR**

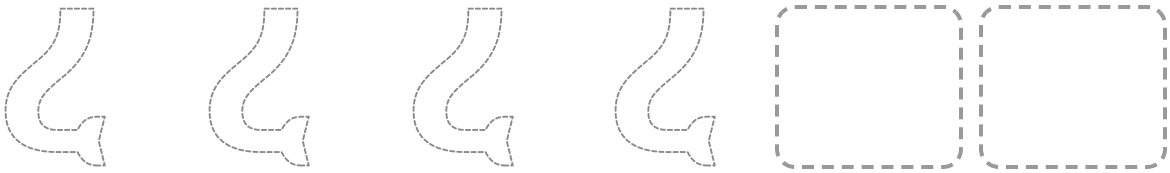
# ሩዝ

*ruz*

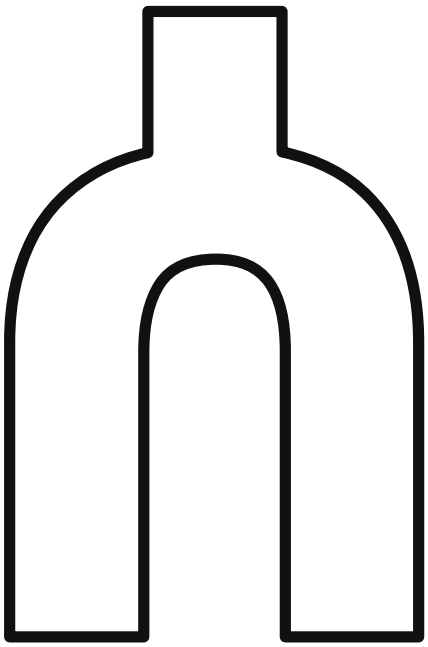
**rice**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ**



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NAME · ስም

# እሳቱ ሰ

*isatu se*

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

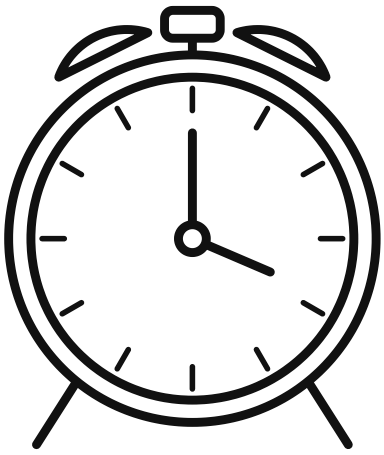
‘s’ as in “sun”

THE ሰ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

| ሰ | ሱ | ሲ | ሳ | ሴ | ስ | ሶ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *se* 1st | *su* 2nd | *si* 3rd | *sa* 4th | *sé* 5th | *s(i)* 6th | *so* 7th |

ሰ *se*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ሰዓት.

Ⴝ and ሰ sound the same; each is kept in its own words.



ሰ IS FOR

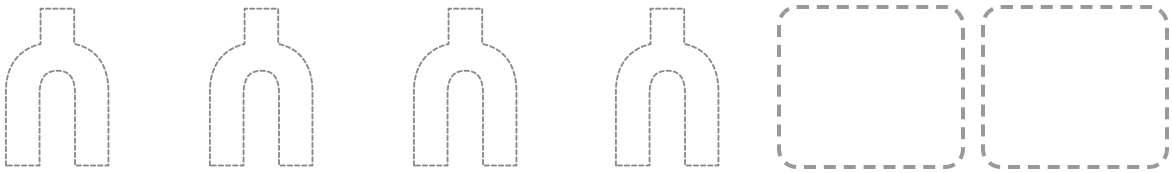
# ሰዓት

*se-'at*

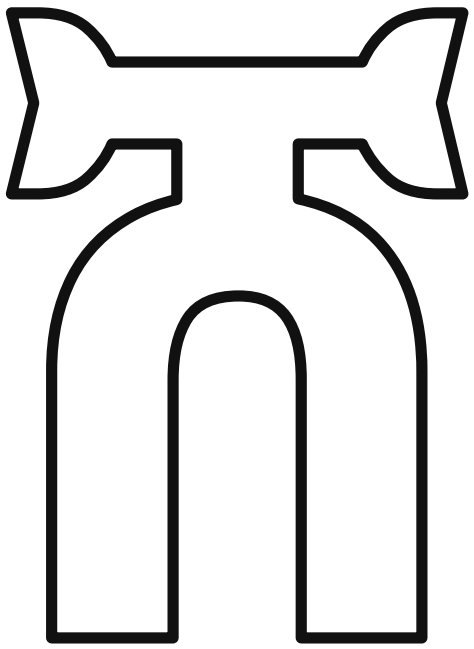
**clock**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ



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**NAME · ስም**

# ሸ

*she*

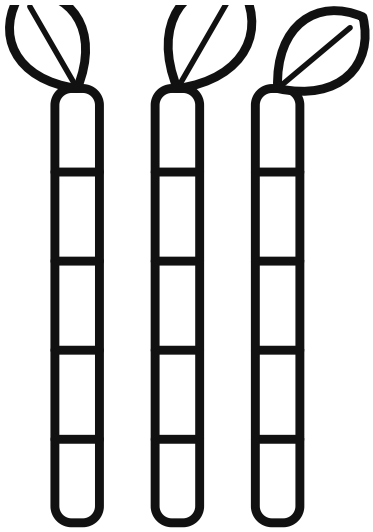
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘sh’ as in “ship”

**THE ሸ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS**

| ሸ | ሹ | ሺ | ሻ | ሼ | ሽ | ሾ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *she* 1st | *shu* 2nd | *shi* 3rd | *sha* 4th | *shé* 5th | *sh(i)* 6th | *sho* 7th |

ሸ *she*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ሸንኮራ.



**ሸ IS FOR**

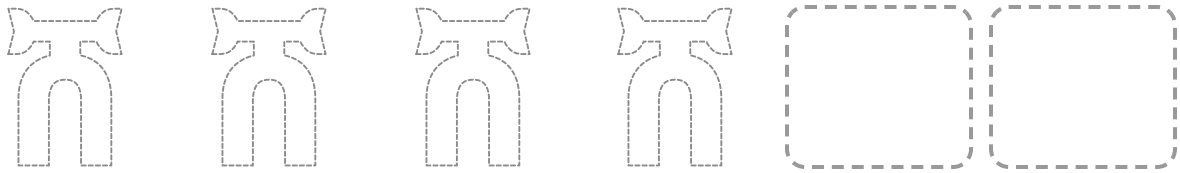
# ሸንኮራ

*shen-ko-ra*

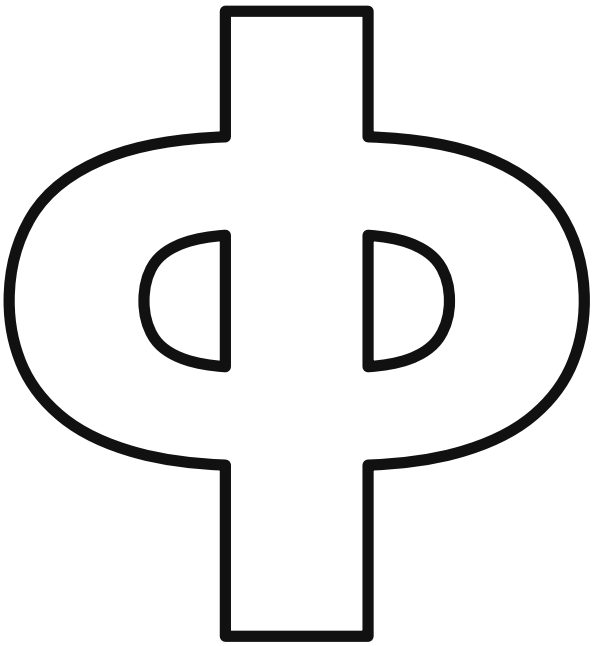
**sugarcane**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ**



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NAME · ስም

# ቀ

*qe*

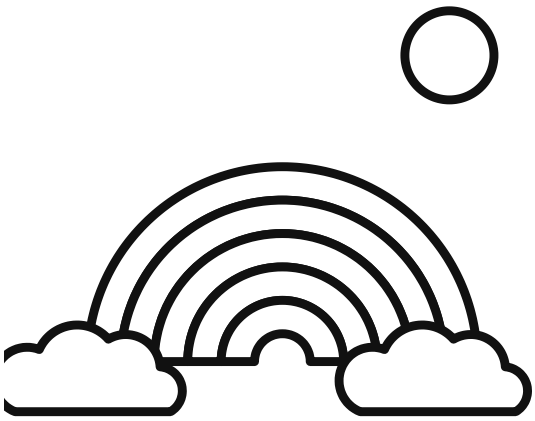
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘q’ — a ‘k’ said far back in the throat (a popped sound: hold your breath, then let the sound burst out)

THE ቀ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

| ቀ | ቁ | ቂ | ቃ | ቄ | ቅ | ቆ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *qe* 1st | *qu* 2nd | *qi* 3rd | *qa* 4th | *qé* 5th | *q(i)* 6th | *qo* 7th |

ቀ *qe*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ቀስተ ደመና.



ቀ IS FOR

# ቀስተ ደመና

*qes-te de-me-na*

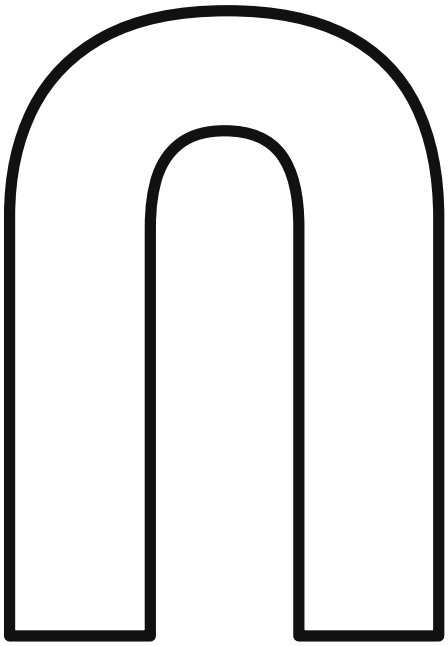
**rainbow**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ

ቀ ቀ ቀ ቀ

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**NAME · ስም**

# በ

*be*

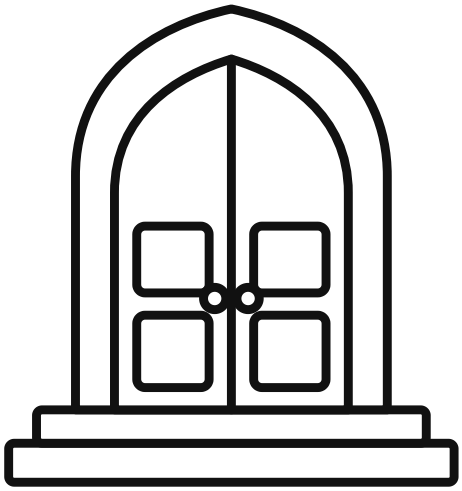
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘b’ as in “ball”

**THE በ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS**

| በ | ቡ | ቢ | ባ | ቤ | ብ | ቦ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *be* 1st | *bu* 2nd | *bi* 3rd | *ba* 4th | *bé* 5th | *b(i)* 6th | *bo* 7th |

በ *be*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word በር.



**በ IS FOR**

# በር

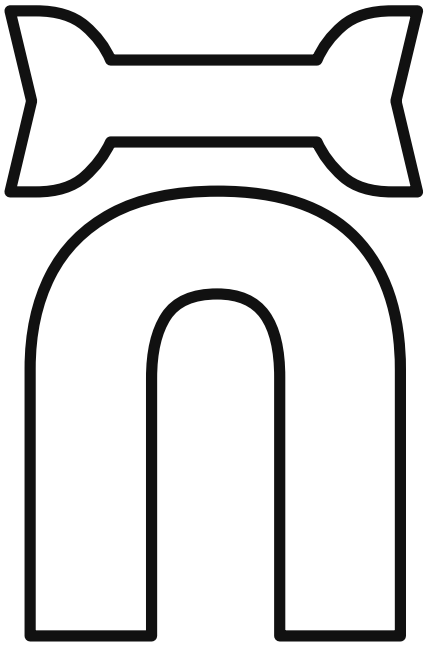
*ber*

**door**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ**

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**NAME · ስም**

# ቨ

*ve*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

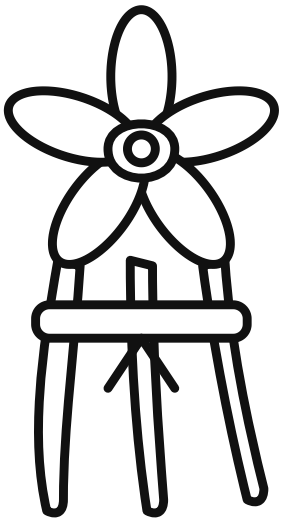
‘v’ as in “van”

**THE ቨ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS**

| ቨ | ቩ | ቪ | ቫ | ቬ | ቭ | ቮ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *ve* 1st | *vu* 2nd | *vi* 3rd | *va* 4th | *vé* 5th | *v(i)* 6th | *vo* 7th |

ቫ *va*, the **4th** sound of this family, starts the word ቫኒላ.

ቨ is a newer letter, used only in words borrowed from other languages.



**ቨ IS FOR**

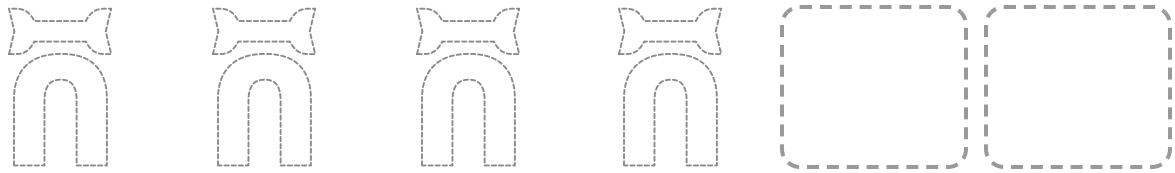
# ቫኒላ

*va-ni-la*

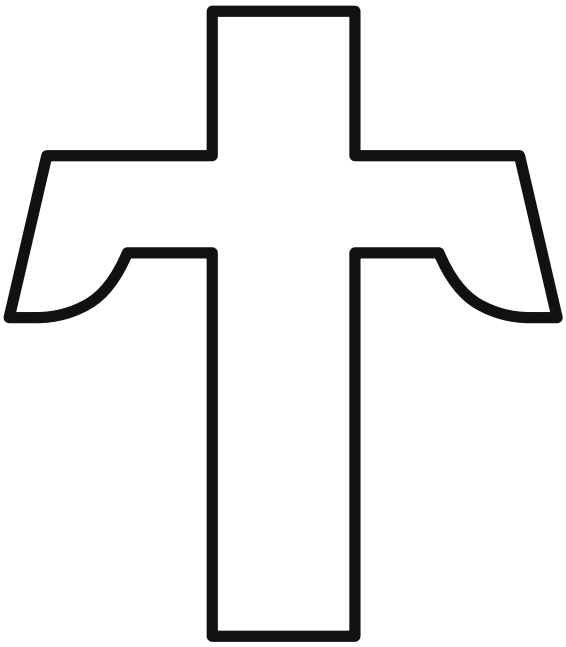
**vanilla (a climbing plant with sweet pods)**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ**



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**NAME · ስም**

# ተ

*te*

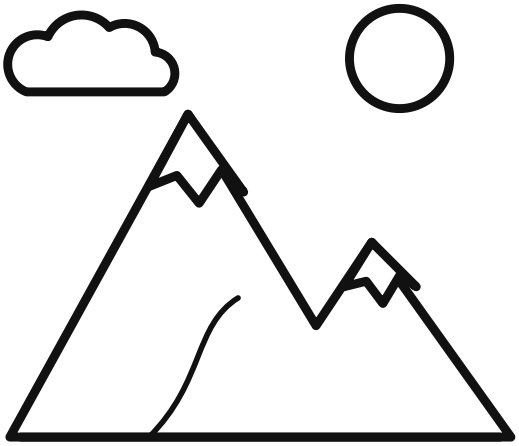
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘t’ as in “top”

**THE ተ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS**

| ተ | ቱ | ቲ | ታ | ቴ | ት | ቶ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *te* 1st | *tu* 2nd | *ti* 3rd | *ta* 4th | *té* 5th | *t(i)* 6th | *to* 7th |

ተ *te*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ተራራ.



**ተ IS FOR**

## ተራራ

*te-ra-ra*

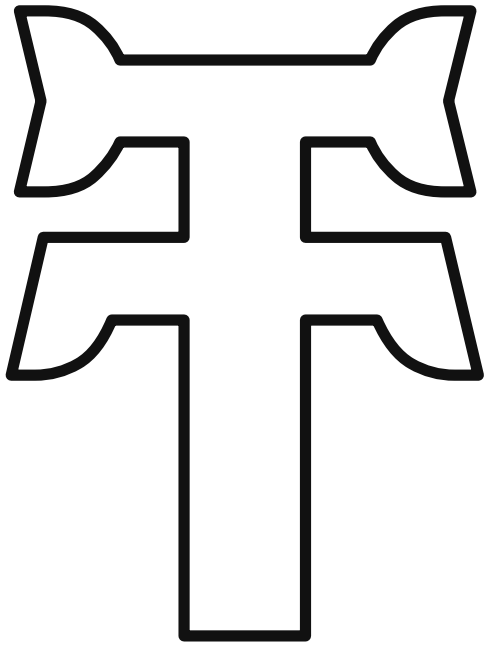
**mountain**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ**

ተ ተ ተ ተ

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NAME · ስም

# ቸ

*che*

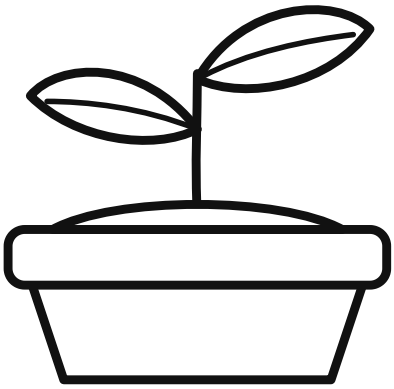
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ch’ as in “chair”

THE ቸ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

| ቸ | ቹ | ቺ | ቻ | ቼ | ች | ቾ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *che* 1st | *chu* 2nd | *chi* 3rd | *cha* 4th | *ché* 5th | *ch(i)* 6th | *cho* 7th |

ች *chi*, the **6th** sound of this family, starts the word ችግኝ.



ቸ IS FOR

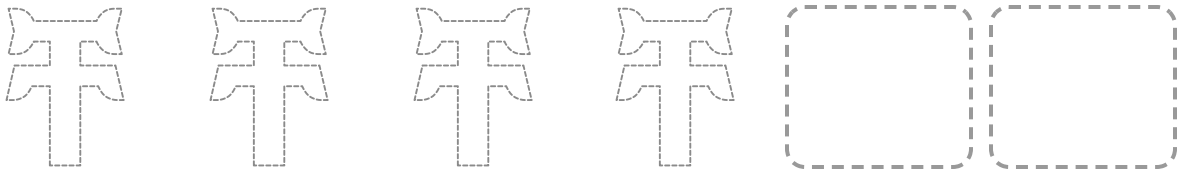
# ችግኝ

*chi-giny*

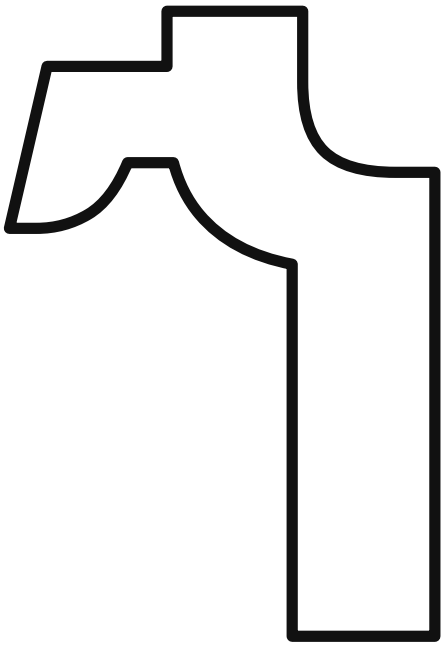
**seedling, a young plant**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ



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NAME · ስም

# ብዙኅኑ ኀ

*bizuhanu ha*

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

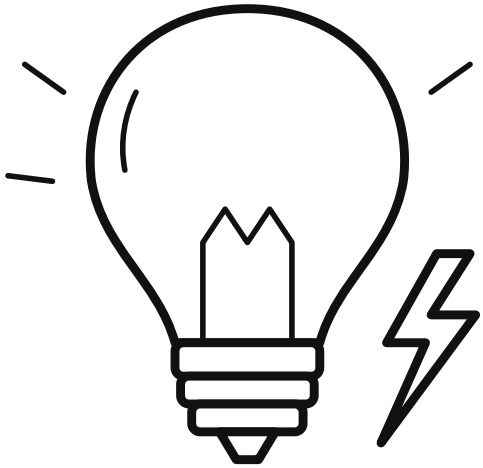
‘h’ as in “hat” — the same sound as ሀ

THE ኀ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

| ኀ | ኁ | ኂ | ኃ | ኄ | ኅ | ኆ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *ha* 1st | *hu* 2nd | *hi* 3rd | *ha* 4th | *hé* 5th | *h(i)* 6th | *ho* 7th |

ኃ *ha*, the **4th** sound of this family, starts the word ኃይል.

ኀ is the rarest of the three h-letters. Children tell them apart by their nicknames.



ኀ IS FOR

# ኃይል

*hayl*

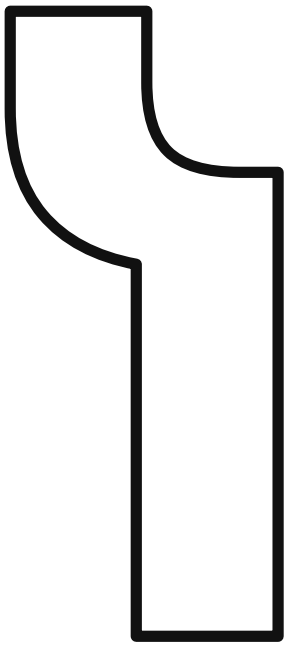
**power, energy**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ

ኀ ኀ ኀ ኀ

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**NAME · ስም**

# ነ

*ne*

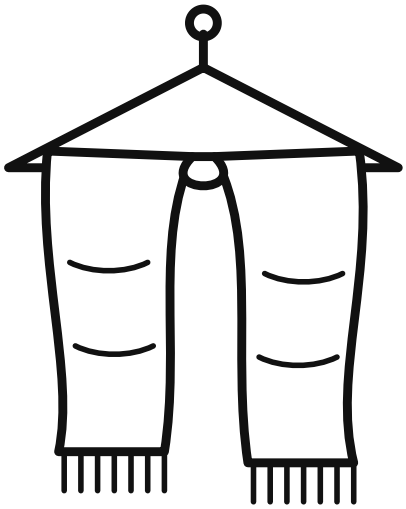
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘n’ as in “net”

**THE ነ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS**

| ነ | ኑ | ኒ | ና | ኔ | ን | ኖ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *ne* 1st | *nu* 2nd | *ni* 3rd | *na* 4th | *né* 5th | *n(i)* 6th | *no* 7th |

ነ *ne*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ነጠላ.



**ነ IS FOR**

# ነጠላ

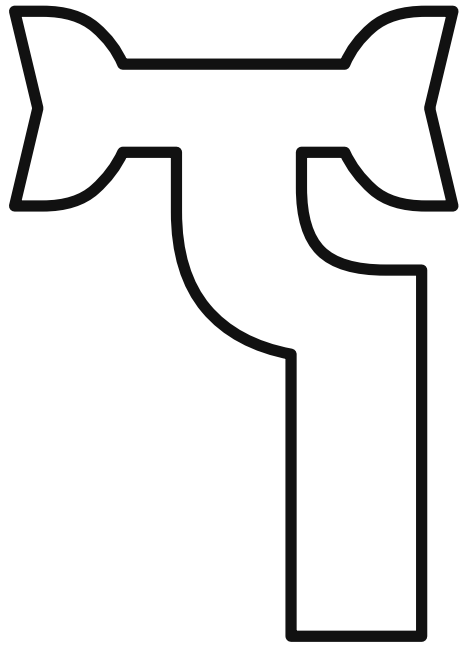
*ne-t'e-la*

**netela, a light cotton shawl**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ**

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**NAME · ስም**

# ኘ

*nye*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘ny’ as in “canyon”

**THE ኘ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS**

| ኘ | ኙ | ኚ | ኛ | ኜ | ኝ | ኞ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *nye* 1st | *nyu* 2nd | *nyi* 3rd | *nya* 4th | *nyé* 5th | *ny(i)* 6th | *nyo* 7th |

ኛ *nya*, the **4th** sound of this family, is found inside the word አማርኛ.

ኘ hardly ever starts a word. Find ኛ at the end of አማርኛ!




**ኘ IS FOR**

# አማርኛ

*a-ma-ri-nya*

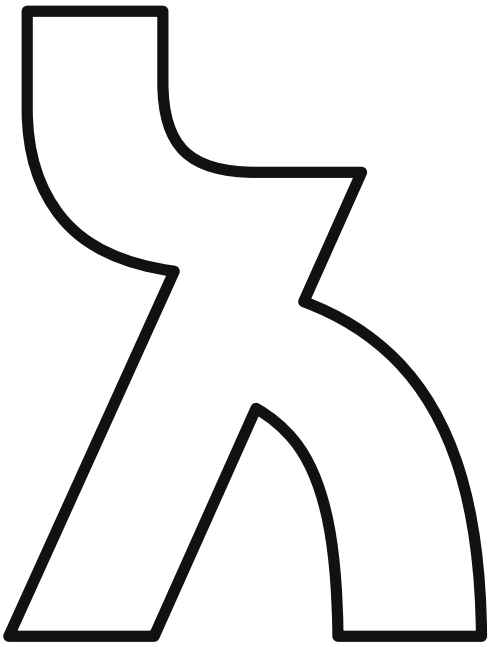
**Amharic — the language of this book!**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ**

ኘ ኘ ኘ ኘ

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NAME · ስም

# አልፋው አ

*alfaw a*

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

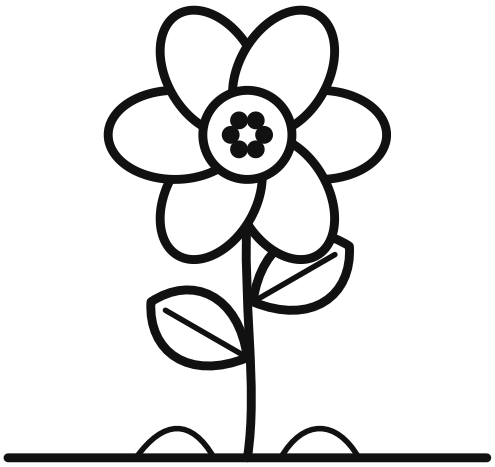
the vowel ‘a’ as in “father” — this family writes the vowels on their own

THE አ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

| አ | ኡ | ኢ | ኣ | ኤ | እ | ኦ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *a* 1st | *u* 2nd | *i* 3rd | *a* 4th | *é* 5th | *i* 6th | *o* 7th |

አ *a*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word አበባ.

አ and ዐ sound the same in Amharic; each is kept in its own words.



አ IS FOR

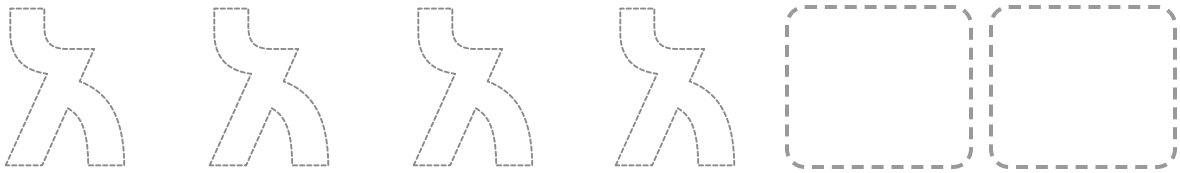
# አበባ

*a-be-ba*

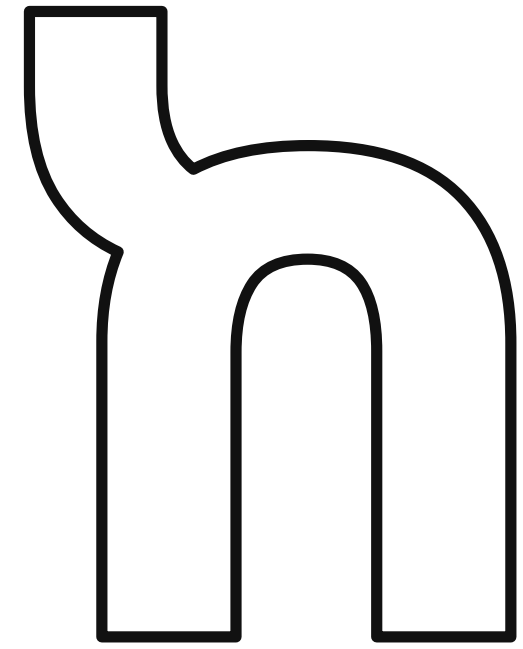
**flower**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ



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**NAME · ስም**

# ከ

*ke*

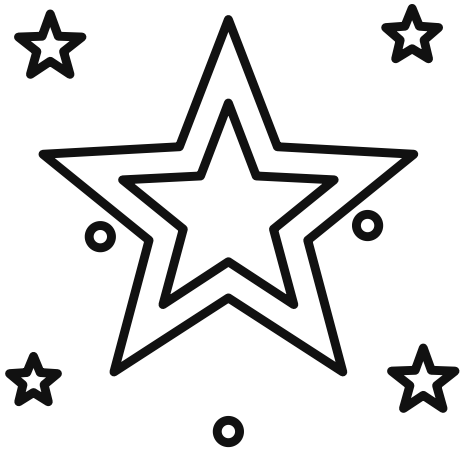
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘k’ as in “kite”

**THE ከ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS**

| ከ | ኩ | ኪ | ካ | ኬ | ክ | ኮ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *ke* 1st | *ku* 2nd | *ki* 3rd | *ka* 4th | *ké* 5th | *k(i)* 6th | *ko* 7th |

ኮ *ko*, the **7th** sound of this family, starts the word ኮከብ.



**ከ IS FOR**

# ኮከብ

*ko-keb*

**star**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ**

ከ ከ ከ ከ

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ወ

NAME · ስም

**ወ**

*we*

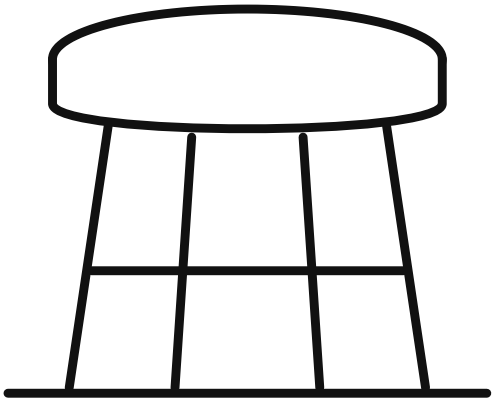
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'w' as in "water"

THE ወ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

| ወ | ዉ | ዊ | ዋ | ዌ | ው | ዎ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *we* 1st | *wu* 2nd | *wi* 3rd | *wa* 4th | *wé* 5th | *w(i)* 6th | *wo* 7th |

ወ *we*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ወንበር.



ወ IS FOR

# ወንበር

*wen-ber*

**chair, stool**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ

ወ ወ ወ ወ

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# ዐ

NAME · ስም

## ዓይኑ 0

*aynu a*

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

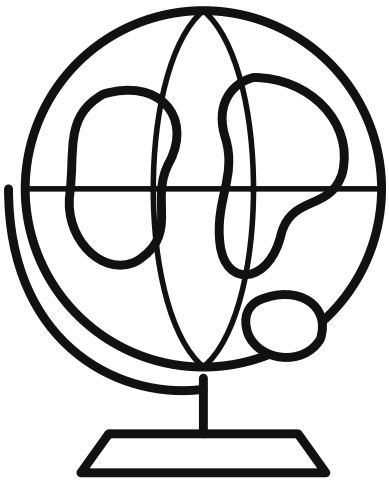
the vowel ‘a’ — the same sound as አ

THE 0 FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

| 0 | ዑ | ዒ | ዓ | ዔ | ዕ | ዖ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *a* 1st | *u* 2nd | *i* 3rd | *a* 4th | *é* 5th | *i* 6th | *o* 7th |

ዓ *a*, the **4th** sound of this family, starts the word ዓለም.

አ and 0 sound the same in Amharic; each is kept in its own words.



0 IS FOR

## ዓለም

*a-lem*

**the world**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ

0 0 0 0

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# ዘ

**NAME · ስም**

## ዘ

*ze*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘z’ as in “zoo”

**THE ዘ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS**

| ዘ | ዙ | ዚ | ዛ | ዜ | ዝ | ዞ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *ze* 1st | *zu* 2nd | *zi* 3rd | *za* 4th | *zé* 5th | *z(i)* 6th | *zo* 7th |

ዝ *zi*, the **6th** sound of this family, starts the word ዝናብ.



**ዘ IS FOR**

## ዝናብ

*zi-nab*

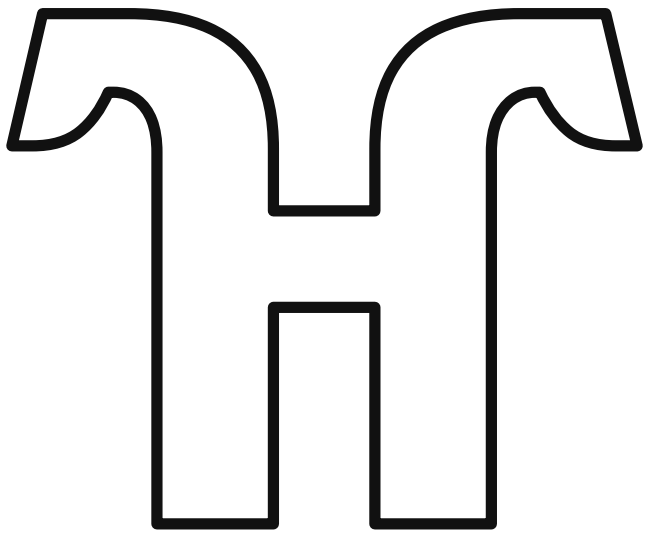
**rain**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ**

ዘ ዘ ዘ ዘ

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NAME · ስም

# ዠ

*zhe*

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘zh’ like the ‘s’ in “measure” — a rare letter

THE ዠ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

| ዠ | ዡ | ዢ | ዣ | ዤ | ዥ | ዦ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *zhe* 1st | *zhu* 2nd | *zhi* 3rd | *zha* 4th | *zhé* 5th | *zh(i)* 6th | *zho* 7th |

ዠ *zha*, the **4th** sound of this family, starts the word ዣንጥላ.



ዠ IS FOR

# ዣንጥላ

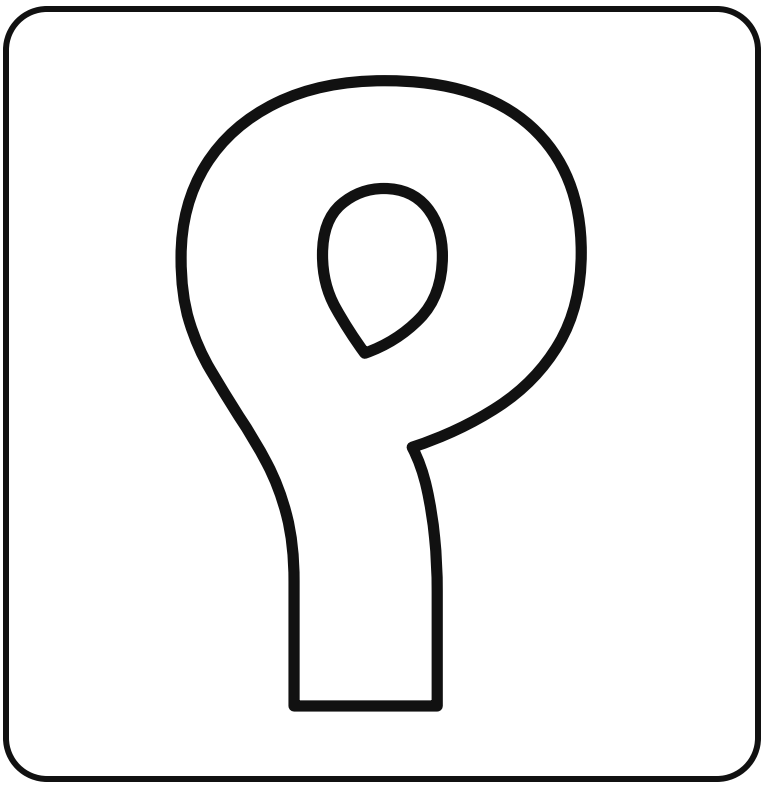
*zhan-t'i-la*

**umbrella**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ

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NAME · ስም

# የ

*ye*

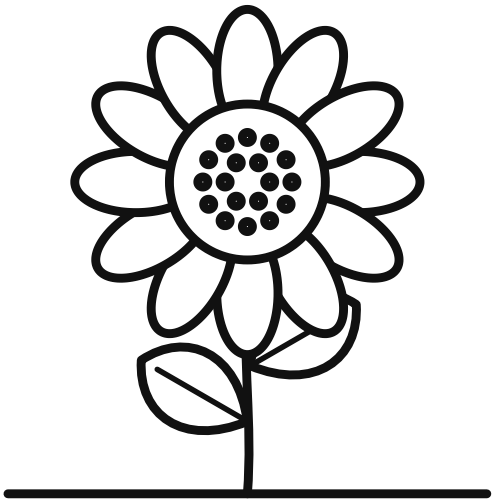
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘y’ as in “yes”

THE የ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

| የ | ዩ | ዪ | ያ | ዬ | ይ | ዮ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *ye* 1st | *yu* 2nd | *yi* 3rd | *ya* 4th | *yé* 5th | *y(i)* 6th | *yo* 7th |

የ *ye*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word የሱፍ አበባ.



የ IS FOR

# የሱፍ አበባ

*ye-suf a-be-ba*

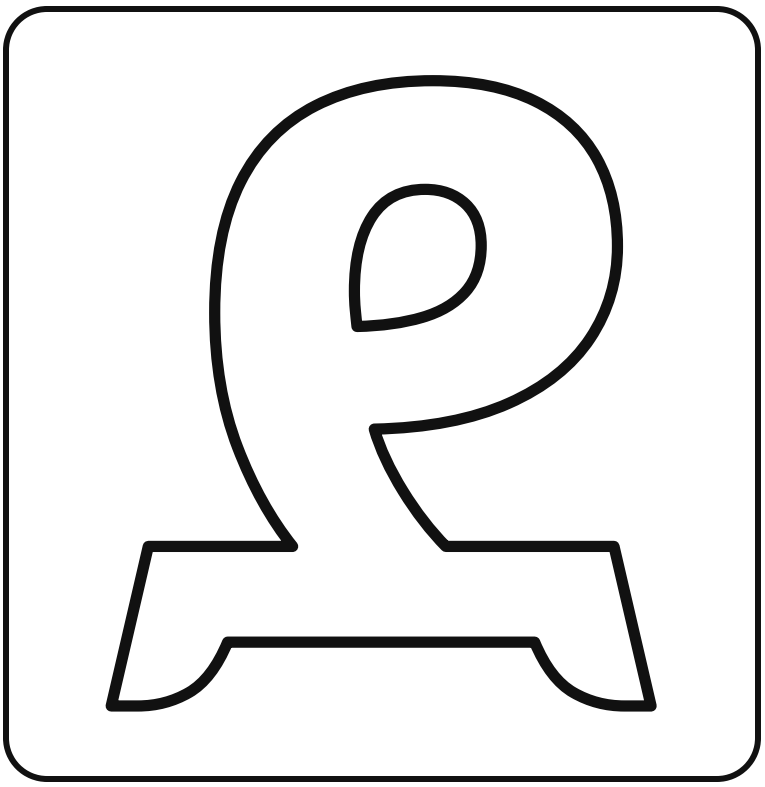
**sunflower**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ



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**NAME · ስም**

# ደ

*de*

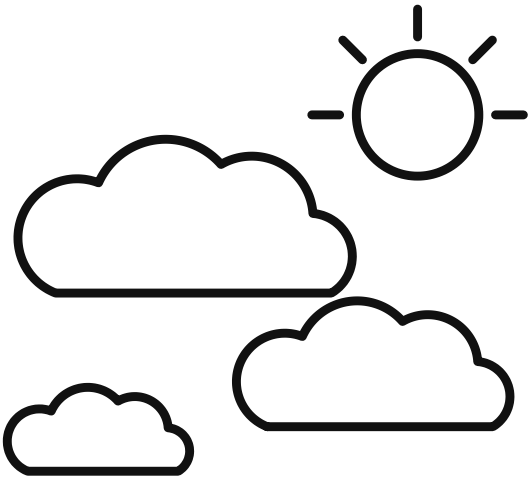
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘d’ as in “door”

**THE ደ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS**

| ደ | ዱ | ዲ | ዳ | ዴ | ድ | ዶ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *de* 1st | *du* 2nd | *di* 3rd | *da* 4th | *dé* 5th | *d(i)* 6th | *do* 7th |

ደ *de*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ደመና.



**ደ IS FOR**

# ደመና

*de-me-na*

**cloud**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ**

ደ ደ ደ ደ

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ጀ

NAME · ስም

ጀ

*je*

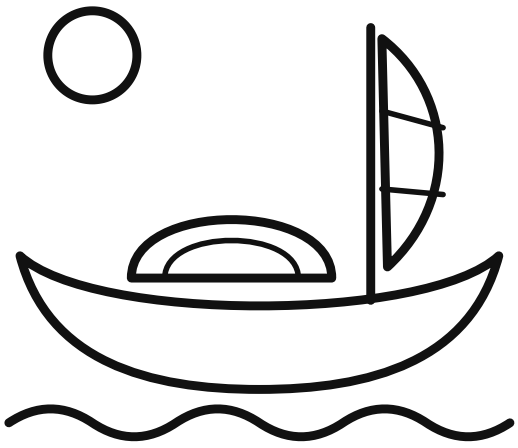
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'j' as in "jam"

THE ጀ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

| ጀ | ጁ | ጂ | ጃ | ጄ | ጅ | ጆ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *je* 1st | *ju* 2nd | *ji* 3rd | *ja* 4th | *jé* 5th | *j(i)* 6th | *jo* 7th |

ጀ *je*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ጀልባ.



ጀ IS FOR

# ጀልባ

*jel-ba*

**boat**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ

ጀ ጀ ጀ ጀ

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ገ

**NAME · ስም**

ገ

*ge*

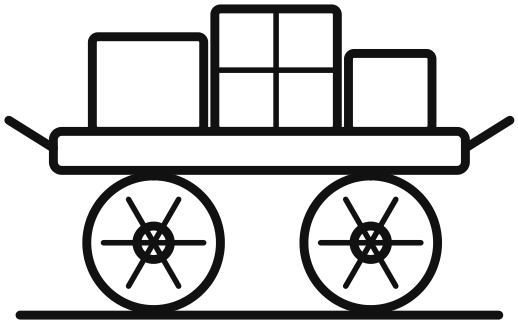
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘g’ as in “go”

**THE ገ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS**

| ገ | ጉ | ጊ | ጋ | ጌ | ግ | ጎ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *ge* 1st | *gu* 2nd | *gi* 3rd | *ga* 4th | *gé* 5th | *g(i)* 6th | *go* 7th |

ጋ *ga*, the **4th** sound of this family, starts the word ጋሪ.



**ገ IS FOR**

# ጋሪ

*ga-ri*

**cart**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ**

ገ ገ ገ ገ

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ጠ

**NAME · ስም**

ጠ

*t'e*

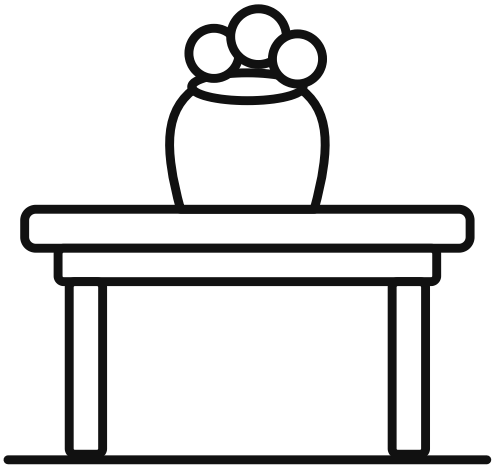
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

a popped ‘t’ (a popped sound: hold your breath, then let the sound burst out)

**THE ጠ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS**

| ጠ | ጡ | ጢ | ጣ | ጤ | ጥ | ጦ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *t'e* 1st | *t'u* 2nd | *t'i* 3rd | *t'a* 4th | *t'é* 5th | *t'(i)* 6th | *t'o* 7th |

ጠ *t'e*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ጠረጴዛ.



**ጠ IS FOR**

# ጠረጴዛ

*t'e-re-p'é-za*

**table**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ**

ጠ ጠ ጠ ጠ

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ቸ ቸ ቸ

NAME · ስም

## ቸ

*ch'e*

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a popped ‘ch’ (a popped sound: hold your breath, then let the sound burst out)

THE ቸ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

| ቸ | ቹ | ቺ | ቻ | ቼ | ች | ቾ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *ch'e* 1st | *ch'u* 2nd | *ch'i* 3rd | *ch'a* 4th | *ch'é* 5th | *ch'(i)* 6th | *ch'o* 7th |

ቸ *ch'e*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ቸረቃ.



ቸ IS FOR

## ቸረቃ

*ch'e-re-qa*

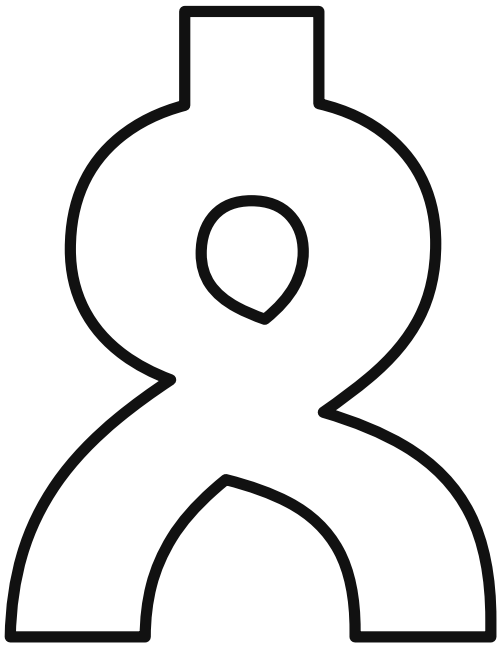
**moon**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ

ቸ ቸ ቸ ቸ

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NAME · ስም

# ጰ

*p'e*

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

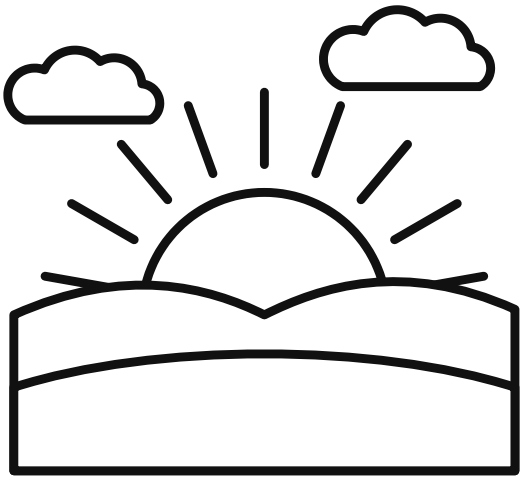
a popped ‘p’ — a rare letter (a popped sound: hold your breath, then let the sound burst out)

THE ጰ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

| ጰ | ጱ | ጲ | ጳ | ጴ | ጵ | ጶ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *p'e* 1st | *p'u* 2nd | *p'i* 3rd | *p'a* 4th | *p'é* 5th | *p'(i)* 6th | *p'o* 7th |

ጳ *p'a*, the **4th** sound of this family, starts the word ጳጉሜ.

The Ethiopian calendar has 13 months: twelve of 30 days, then ጳጉሜ with 5 or 6 days.



ጰ IS FOR

# ጳጉሜ

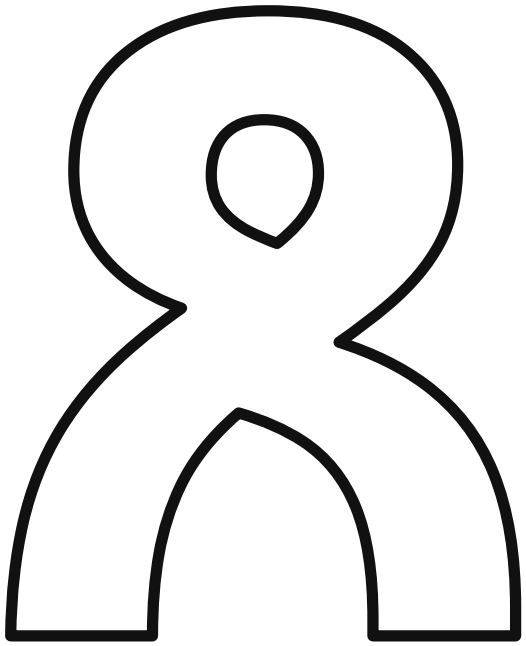
*p'a-gu-mé*

## Pagumé, the short 13th month

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጰፍ

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NAME · ስም

# ጸሎቱ ጸ

*ts'elotu ts'e*

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

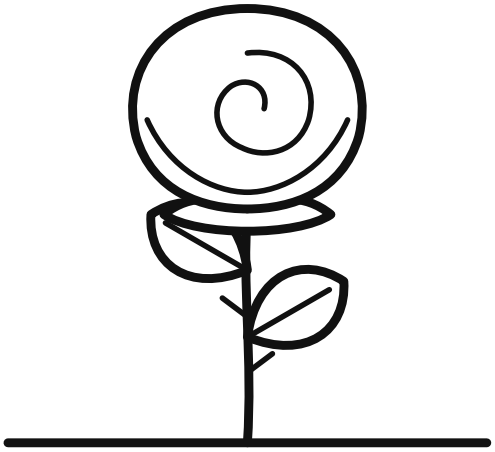
a popped ‘ts’ (a popped sound: hold your breath, then let the sound burst out)

THE ጸ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

| ጸ | ጹ | ጺ | ጻ | ጼ | ጽ | ጾ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *ts'e* 1st | *ts'u* 2nd | *ts'i* 3rd | *ts'a* 4th | *ts'é* 5th | *ts'(i)* 6th | *ts'o* 7th |

ጽ *ts'i*, the **6th** sound of this family, starts the word ጽጌረዳ.

ጸ and ፀ sound the same; each is kept in its own words.



ጸ IS FOR

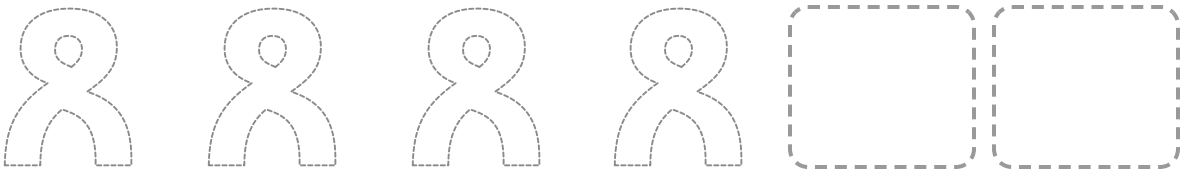
# ጽጌረዳ

*ts'i-gé-re-da*

**rose**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ



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ፀ

NAME · ስም

# ፀሐዩ ፀ

*ts'ehayu ts'e*

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

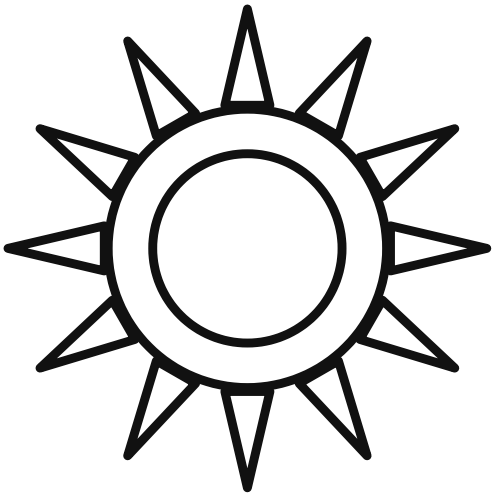
a popped ‘ts’ — the same sound as ጸ

THE ፀ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

| ፀ | ፁ | ፂ | ፃ | ፄ | ፅ | ፆ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *ts'e* 1st | *ts'u* 2nd | *ts'i* 3rd | *ts'a* 4th | *ts'é* 5th | *ts'(i)* 6th | *ts'o* 7th |

ፀ *ts'e*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ፀሐይ.

ጸ and ፀ sound the same; each is kept in its own words.



ፀ IS FOR

# ፀሐይ

*ts'e-hay*

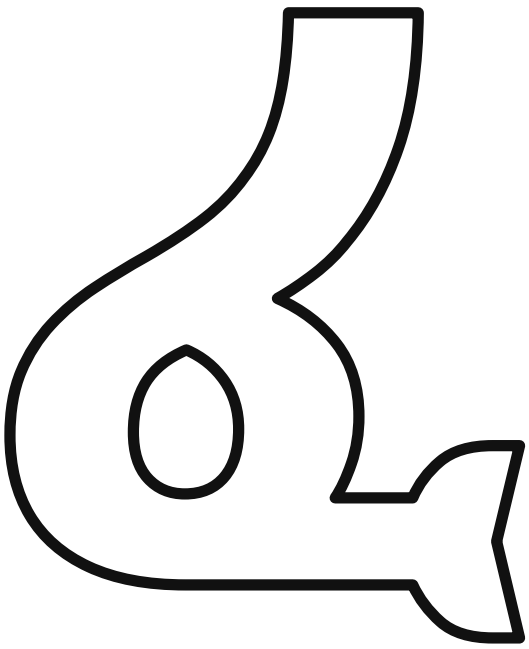
**sun**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ

ፀ ፀ ፀ ፀ

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NAME · ስም

# ፈ

*fe*

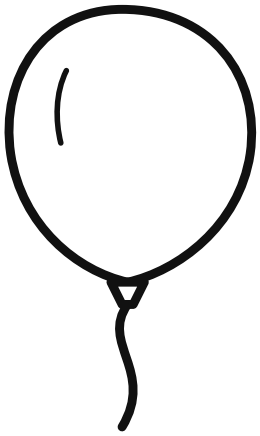
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘f’ as in “fan”

THE ፈ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

| ፈ | ፉ | ፊ | ፋ | ፌ | ፍ | ፎ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *fe* 1st | *fu* 2nd | *fi* 3rd | *fa* 4th | *fé* 5th | *f(i)* 6th | *fo* 7th |

ፊ *fi*, the **3rd** sound of this family, starts the word ፊኛ.



ፈ IS FOR

# ፊኛ

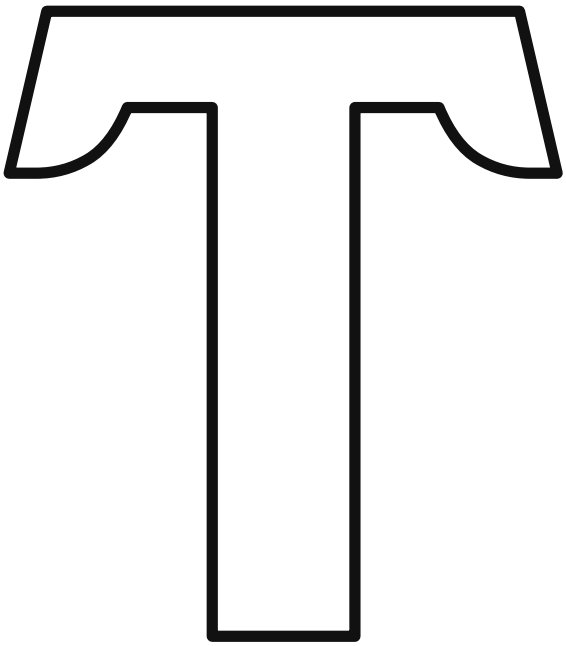
*fi-nya*

**balloon**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ

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**NAME · ስም**

# ፐ

*pe*

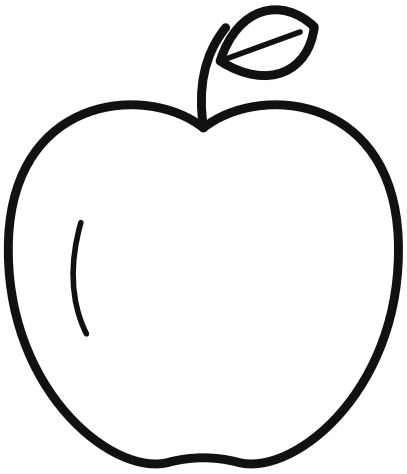
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘p’ as in “pen”

**THE ፐ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS**

| ፐ | ፑ | ፒ | ፓ | ፔ | ፕ | ፖ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *pe* 1st | *pu* 2nd | *pi* 3rd | *pa* 4th | *pé* 5th | *p(i)* 6th | *po* 7th |

*ፖ po*, the **7th** sound of this family, starts the word *ፖም*.



**ፐ IS FOR**

# ፖም

*pom*

**apple**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ**

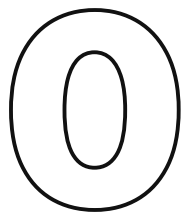
ፐ ፐ ፐ ፐ

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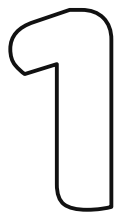
BONUS

# Amharic numbers ቁጥሮች *(qu-t'i-roch)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Amharic: *zé-ro, and, hu-let, sost...*



**0**
**ዜሮ**
*zé-ro*
zero



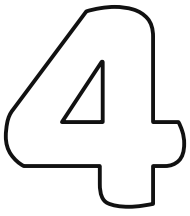
**1**
**አንድ**
*and*
one · ፩



**2**
**ሁለት**
*hu-let*
two · ፪



**3**
**ሦስት**
*sost*
three · ፫



**4**
**አራት**
*a-rat*
four · ፬



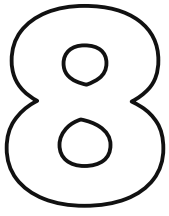
**5**
**አምስት**
*a-mist*
five · ፭



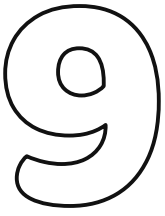
**6**
**ስድስት**
*sid-ist*
six · ፮



**7**
**ሰባት**
*se-bat*
seven · ፯



**8**
**ስምንት**
*si-mint*
eight · ፰



**9**
**ዘጠኝ**
*ze-t'eny*
nine · ፱

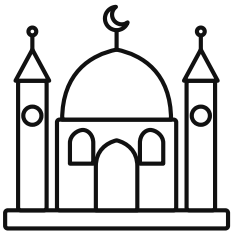
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LET'S TALK

# My first Amharic words የመጀመሪያ ቃላት

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

| | |
|---|---|
| አሰላሙ ዐለይኩም | *as-se-la-mu a-ley-kum*<br>**Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)** |
| ወዐለይኩም አሰላም | *we-a-ley-kum as-se-lam*<br>**And upon you be peace (the reply)** |
| ሰላም! | *se-lam!*<br>**Hello!** |
| ስሜ ... ነው | *si-mé ... new*<br>**My name is ...** |
| አመሰግናለሁ | *a-me-se-gi-na-le-hu*<br>**Thank you** |
| ጀዛከላሁ ኸይራን | *je-za-ke-la-hu khey-ran*<br>**May Allah reward you with good** |
| እናት · አባት | *i-nat · a-bat*<br>**Mother · Father** |
| ወንድም · እህት | *wen-dim · i-hit*<br>**Brother · Sister** |
| አዎ · አይ | *a-wo · ay*<br>**Yes · No** |
| አማርኛ እየተማርኩ ነው! | *a-ma-ri-nya i-ye-te-mar-ku new!*<br>**I am learning Amharic!** |







REFERENCES & SOURCES

# Where our facts come from

[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

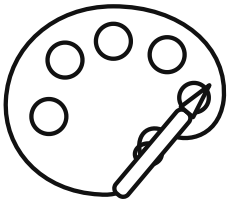
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International), rounded; first- and second-language speakers together.

**What's next?**
You have met all **33 Amharic letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Amharic, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

**Enjoyed this book?**
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*





# Certificate of Achievement

## ማሻአላህ! በጣም ጎበዝ!

*ma-sha-al-lah! be-t'am go-bez! — Mashallah! Well done!*

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
**all 33 letters of the Amharic alphabet**.

Date _____ Grown-up's signature _____

*Minhaz Reza*

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author



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